

SUNGHYUN PARK

Seoul, Republic of Korea | +82 010-9250-4664 | parksunghyun@yonsei.ac.kr

RESEARCH PROFILE

Scholar investigating how digital platforms shape participation, inequality, and user agency in contemporary mediated environments. My research examines how platform infrastructures organize cultural participation, belonging, mobility, and access, while also producing uneven conditions of inclusion and exclusion. Drawing on qualitative methods, I situate my work at the intersection of media studies, information studies, and critical platform research.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Dynamics of Platform Power and User Agency
- Digital Inequality and Mediated Cultural Participation
- Digital Infrastructures and Critical Governance Research
- Intersections of Media, Technology, and Society
- Mediated Experience and Contemporary Digital Spatiality
- Social Class, Cultural Capital, and Educational Experience

CURRENT RESEARCH AGENDA

A. Platform Affordances, User Agency, and Mediated Experience

Building upon my master's research, examines how platform architectures structure participation, mobility, sensory engagement, and belonging in digitally mediated environments. Investigates how platform design produces differential conditions of inclusion, exclusion, and agency across emerging digital spaces.

B. Digital Financial Subject Formation in the South Korean Military

Examines how the introduction of personal smartphone access among South Korean soldiers following the 2019 military policy reform exposed soldiers to digital financial platforms, investment cultures, and entrepreneurial aspirations. Investigates whether participation in digital financial ecosystems contributes to new forms of economic subject formation and reshapes everyday military culture within traditionally closed institutional environments.

C. Platform Power and Public Discourse Following Data Breaches

Investigates how large-scale personal data breaches in South Korea become politically mobilized through public discourse. Rather than treating privacy violations solely as technical or legal issues, examines how such incidents are incorporated into broader struggles over legitimacy, responsibility,

and power, contributing to asymmetric discursive hierarchies within digital society.

EDUCATION

M.A. in Media and Cultural Studies

Yonsei University, Graduate School of Communication & Arts, Seoul, Republic of Korea

GPA: 4.07 / 4.3

Thesis: *Sense of Place in Digital Travel: User Experience in Online Guided Tours and Metaverse Travel*

In-depth interview study (N=12) on how users form place attachment in digitally mediated travel. Findings show platform structures—medium/platform, surrogate agents, digital locals, co-participants—determine how actively users experience mediated spaces. Users construct "reflective sense of place" by reorganizing sensory engagement, yet platform-imposed behavioral constraints (limited sensory modalities, restricted mobility, fragmented temporality) systematically undermine ownership and belonging, positioning users as constrained observers. Platform architectures do not neutrally deliver experience but actively structure conditions of participation and agency.

B.A. in Global Media & Communication Arts

Woosong University, Daejeon, Republic of Korea

Minor: Global Business | GPA: 3.94 / 4.5

Graduate Project: *Living as an Elder in the 21st Century* — Visual ethnographic study on how elderly populations navigate digital inequality, documenting structural barriers constraining older adults' access to digitized public services.

PUBLICATIONS

[Refereed Journal Article]

Park, S., Schutte, S., & Park, S. (2025). K-Pop and Education Migration to Korea in the Digitalised COVID Era. *Social Sciences*, 14(6), 390. <https://doi.org/10.3390/socsci14060390>

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Park, S. (2023, August). A Study on the Discrimination of 'Rental' Apartments Reproduced in TV Dramas: Focusing on TV Chosun's Drama *Uncle*. Paper presented at the 2023 Cultural Studies Camp, Korean Association for Body & Cultural Studies (KABS), Republic of Korea.

Park, S., Park, S., & Schutte, S. (2022). K-Pop and Education Migration to Korea in the Digitalised COVID-19 Era. Paper presented at the Korean Association for the Study of Popular Music, Republic of Korea.

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Activist, Center for Media Responsibility and Human Rights

Seoul, Republic of Korea | 02/2026 – Present

- Research media-related human rights violations and contribute to policy reports on digital rights, platform accountability, and user protection in South Korea.
- Develop educational programs on media responsibility, with emphasis on platform governance and individual rights in digital communication environments.
- Participate in civil society research initiatives on media regulation and digital infrastructure policy.

Professional Monitor for Protection of Rights, Korea Communication Standard Commission

Seoul, Republic of Korea | 10/2022 – Present

- Monitor broadcast and digital platform content for compliance with media governance standards; produce analytical reports on patterns of rights violations and regulatory effectiveness.
- Conduct thematic monitoring research on platform-mediated speech, user-generated content regulation, and cross-platform governance gaps, informing policy discussions on content moderation.
- Analyze how regulatory frameworks operationalize categories of permissible/impermissible content, contributing to understanding of governance gaps between broadcast and digital media.

Participation in Culture Division, Sejong City Youth Policy Network

Sejong City, Republic of Korea | 03/2023 – 12/2023

- Proposed digital infrastructure policy for a database archive of youth cultural activities, contributing to municipal deliberations on cultural data governance.
- Drafted policy proposal for Sejong City Council on how digital infrastructure design affects accessibility and sustainability of local cultural archives.

Promoting Activity, Korea Heritage Agency

Seoul, Republic of Korea | 03/2021 – 05/2021

- Produced content for the 2021 Royal Culture Festival, investigating how platform-mediated cultural experiences shape public perception of traditional heritage.

- Analyzed user engagement metrics (40% increase in social media interaction) examining how digital platform strategies influence audience engagement with cultural institutions.

Oboist, Korea Army Academy at Yeongcheon Band

Republic of Korea Army Band | Yeongcheon-si, Gyeongsangbuk-do | 07/2017 – 01/2021

- Performed at national and international diplomatic events, including joint performances with U.S. military forces.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- Student Member, International Communication Association (ICA), 2026–Present
- Member, Shinchon Center for Cultural-Politics Research

RESEARCH METHODS AND SKILLS

- **Qualitative Methods:** In-depth Interview, Thematic Analysis, Visual Ethnography
- **Research Design:** Qualitative Study Design, Theoretical Framework Development
- **Digital Media:** Adobe Premiere Pro, Photoshop, Illustrator

LANGUAGES

- Korean (Native)
- English (Advanced; IELTS 7.0)
- Spanish (Beginner)

